
SCITI 2026

Smart City Thailand Index

Reality, not ribbon-cutting.

Digital Economy Promotion Agency (depa)
Ministry of Digital Economy and Society (MDES)
Kingdom of Thailand

SLIC Methodology | April 2026 | SCITI-2026-R1
Pronounced "City" (silent S)

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1. Executive Summary

Thailand has certified 37 smart cities across 4 batches since 2019. But how many actually work? This index measures reality — what citizens experience — not what was presented on a slide deck. 118 cities tracked. 39 operational. 15 Alpha tier.

Built on SLIC methodology with 7 weighted pillars: Livability (25%), Economy (20%), Safety (15%), Wellbeing (15%), Environment (10%), Hospitality (10%), Digital (5%). Formula: Composite = $\text{Sum}(\text{Pillar} \times \text{Weight}) / \text{Sum}(\text{Weights})$.

2. Top 10 Cities

#	City	Province	Score	Tier
1	Phuket	Phuket	72.8	Alpha
2	Samyan	Bangkok	72.4	Alpha
3	Chiang Mai Old Town	Chiang Mai	71.1	Alpha
4	Khon Kaen	Khon Kaen	70.2	Alpha
5	CMU Smart City	Chiang Mai	70.1	Alpha
6	Saensuk	Chon Buri	67.5	Alpha
7	Phra Ram 4	Bangkok	66.9	Alpha
8	Krabi	Krabi	66.5	Alpha
9	Chachoengsao	Chachoengsao	66.4	Alpha
10	Hat Yai	Songkhla	66.1	Alpha

3. Scoring Methodology

Pillar	Weight	Signals
Livability	25%	Housing, transit, infrastructure
Economy	20%	Jobs, GPP, growth
Safety	15%	Crime, disaster resilience
Wellbeing	15%	Healthcare, education
Environment	10%	PM2.5, green space, waste
Hospitality	10%	Culture, community, tourism
Digital	5%	IoT, data platforms, AI

Alpha >= 65 (operational) | Beta 45-64 (building) | Gamma < 45 (planning)

4. Data Sources (15+)

- NSO — population, income
- NESDC — GPP per capita
- PCD — PM2.5 (70+ stations)
- GISTDA — satellite green coverage
- World Bank — GDP, Gini
- ADB — infrastructure finance
- Open-Meteo/Copernicus — climate
- Royal Thai Police — crime
- DOPA — population registry
- depa citydata.in.th — IoT
- MOPH — hospital beds
- BOI — FDI, investment
- ONEP — environmental index
- Royal Forest Dept — forest cover
- Field observation — site verification

5. Financial Toolkit

15 instruments based on ASEAN Smart City Financing Toolkit, ADB ACGF, Thailand SEC Green Bond Framework, BOI S-Curve:

- PPP (500M-10B+)
- Green Bond (1-20B)
- Land Value Capture
- Municipal Bond
- BOT
- ADB/JICA/WB Dev Finance
- Blended Finance
- BOI Incentives
- Gov Transfer
- TA Grant
- Crowdfunding
- On-Bill Financing
- Smart City SEZ
- Land Pooling
- Asset Recycling

6. Standards Alignment

- UN-Habitat CPI
- ISO 37122:2019
- SDG 11
- ASCF 2018
- ASCAP 2021-2025
- New Urban Agenda 2016
- Thailand PPP Act B.E. 2562